postures, emphasis and intonations on some words, and the physical distance between the sender and receiver.

Advantages:

- The message of non verbal communication reaches very fast and reduces the waste of time.
- Non verbal cues of communication like sign and symbols can be communicated quickly than written or oral messages.
- Helps illiterate people.

Disadvantages:

- Non verbal communication is vague because words or languages are not used.
- Long conversation and necessary explanation are not possible.
- It cannot be used at public tool for communication.
- In some cases it involves huge cost. e.g. neon sign, power point presentation etc. are very much costly compared to the other forms of communication.

C. Written communication

It is a formal method of communication. It can provide more information to the receiver that what is not possible in oral communication. Oral communications may take the forms of reports, circular, memos, note, manual etc. writing is more reliable than speech.

Advantages of written communication:

- Suitable for lengthy matters.
- At times it might be the only available form of communication (as in long distance transactions).
- Can be maintained as a permanent record for later references.

Disadvantages of written communication:

- Time consuming and sometimes costly.
- Has a greater chance of mis-interpretation and misunderstanding.
- Difficult to maintain secrecy.
- Suffer from lack of flexibility.

7.21 Barriers to Communication

As we have mentioned earlier in this chapter, the communication process is hardly a simple one. It surely suffers from a lot of potential problems within the organisation which are called the barriers to communication. In fact, these can take place at each step of the communication process viz. encoding, decoding, etc. The barriers to communication can be listed as follows.

1. Results when the content of communication is not encoded properly. The communicator may be either too fast or too confused in presenting the matter.
2. Distortion in communication can take place particularly, when it has to pass through a number of layers as happens in multi-layered organisations.
3. Distrust of communicator may inhibit the process of communication, as the individual might not open up because of his lack of trust towards the other.
4. The flow of communication may also be restricted at some point of time in the process of communication.
5. Poor retention may be another source of barriers to communication as people tend to forget up to 50% atleast of what they have communicated.
6. Unattention may also be a potential barrier to communication.

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